UK SMALL BUSINESS CYBER OUTLOOK 2027

Three themes, the rules that change, and a plan that fits on one sheet of A4.

For UK firms with 5 to 50 staff

Swipe →

THE NUMBER ON EVERY VENDOR SLIDE

43%

of UK businesses "identified a breach or attack" last year.

It counts phishing emails that arrived and did nothing. Nobody clicked. Nothing was lost.

The honest number is 1 in 5. Take phishing out and it's 1 in 33.

Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26 (DSIT)

WHAT SHAPES 2027

THREE THEMES. ONE RULEBOOK.

1

OTHER PEOPLE'S PROBLEMS BECOME YOURS

Suppliers, IT providers and big customers are now your attack surface.

2

AI IN THE BACK OFFICE

Tools nobody approved, tricked by what they read.

3

CRIME GETS CHEAPER AND FASTER

Convincing scams cost less. Flaws are exploited in days.

+

THE RULES CHANGE

Cyber Essentials tightens. IT providers come into regulation.

Swipe →

THEME 1 · OTHER PEOPLE'S PROBLEMS

THE ATTACK THAT STOPS YOU MAY START SOMEWHERE ELSE

UP TO

5,000

organisations hit by the Jaguar Land Rover attack, mainly through the supply chain

12%

of micro firms have reviewed the cyber risk from their immediate suppliers

Prolific North, Oct 2025 · Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26

AI IS ALREADY IN YOUR INBOX. WHO DECIDED THAT?

31%

of businesses are using, adopting or considering AI

24%

of those have any practice in place to manage the risk

> *Prompt injection "may never be totally mitigated."*

Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26 · NCSC, Dec 2025

THEME 3 · CRIME GETS CHEAPER AND FASTER

£576m

lost to authorised push payment fraud in the UK in 2025. **Up 19%.**

The gap between a flaw being published and a criminal using it is now days, and the NCSC expects AI to shrink it further.

UK Finance via Fintech Futures · NCSC, May 2025

PLUS · THE RULES CHANGE

THE CONTRACT WILL GET YOU BEFORE THE REGULATOR DOES

Cyber Essentials now fails any applicant without multi-factor authentication on cloud services where it's available.

The Cyber Security and Resilience Bill brings medium and large IT providers into regulation, with 24-hour incident reporting.

Expect both in your customers' supplier questionnaires during 2027.

IASME, Feb 2026 · UK Parliament bill page

THE FIGURES THAT WORRY ME MOST

THE BAR IS LOW. THAT'S THE OPPORTUNITY.

21%

of micro firms have a formal incident response plan

29%

have an owner or board member named as responsible for cyber

Formal cyber policies in small businesses fell from **59% to 52%** in a year.

Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26

NO BIG BUDGET NEEDED

FIVE THINGS TO DO BEFORE JANUARY

1. Switch on multi-factor authentication for every cloud service, starting with email.
2. Agree a call-back rule for any change to bank details or urgent payment.
3. Ask your IT provider four questions (they're in the report).
4. List your five key suppliers, five key customers and the AI tools your staff use.
5. Fill in the one-page plan and print it.

FREE TO USE · NO SIGN-UP

TAKE THE TWO-MINUTE CHECK

cyberoutlook.sbcsg.uk/check

Ten questions, a score out of 10 and your gaps in order, for UK firms with five to 50 staff.



Noel Bradford
The Small Business Cyber Security Guy
Nine podcast episodes, Mondays from 2 November 2026

Link in the comments